

10.2.2 overflow:hidden

There are occasions when you don't want the overflowing content to show, or you only wish it to appear in certain circumstances. This is where `overflow:hidden` comes in handy. For example, you might have a beautiful photograph of some mountains that you wish to use as a banner image. This image is 796 pixels wide, and you know that if you add it to the page, it will always force the site to be at least that wide, and would force horizontal scrollbars if the window was decreased below that width.

For this example, we will use an image that is 796 pixels in width by 320 pixels in height. The image needs to be placed into the (X)HTML page as follows:

```
<div id="masthead"><a href="#"></a></div>
```

You can see the context into which the banner will be placed. Following that, the CSS for the masthead ID is shown. Note that the width is a percentage value (100%) ensuring the masthead always fills the available space. The height is equal to that of the image it will hold. Finally, `overflow:hidden` is specified.

```
/* Container for all page content */
#container {
border:1px solid #000;
padding:20px;
background-color:#FFF;
}
/* Masthead */
#masthead {
width:100%;
height:320px;
border:2px solid #999;
background:#CCC;
overflow:hidden;
}
```

That is all you need to do. In the browser under normal circumstances, the thinnest window would force a horizontal scrollbar due to the larger width of the image. Thanks to hiding the overflow, this is skilfully avoided.